It Feels Like an Eternity (since I had you here with me)

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by Anonymous

Summary

Phainon would always love Mydei.

Even as the cycles ticked on, even as he killed him, watched him, fought him, and lost to him.

That love would never waver.

Notes

Yes, I'm that anon author, I decided it was time for a 'Non-Dark Anon Works' Series as well.

See the end of the work for more notes

It was one of his biggest regrets that he no longer really remembered what it was like to meet Mydei for the first time. He remembered the events, of course he did, he remembered nearly everything from every *single* one of the cycles, but the exact emotions…? They alluded him, no matter how many years he spent thinking and thinking and *thinking* back, trying to claw back that beautiful, broken memory of love and loss.

It never did him any good. No matter what he did.

He remembered the love afterward though. He had been as naïve as a child, wide eyed and bright smiles that hadn't dimmed yet. That first cycle…

Why had Mydei even fallen in love with him? Him, the nobody from nowhere, hand always clasped in Cyrene's hand, unless they were separated by her studies. Him, who laughed at stupid things and had a *horrible* sleep schedule. Him, who could never even *dream* of getting anywhere close to the exiled Prince of Castrum Kremnos.

And yet…

Competition upon competition.

Late nights turning into early mornings.

Meals once had alone now joined by another.

Eventually, that friendship becoming… more.

They hadn't ever kept it secret, though they never really advertised it either. The other Chrysos Heirs knew, several of the more eagle-eyed Okheman and Kremnoan soldiers, the *Chimeras*, for some reason. They had kept it from the Council, Aglaea's murmured words infecting them both with her justified paranoia.

They had never been anything official, had never dared to challenge the universe by giving what they had a title. He had believed that while Mydei was destined for great things, was invincible, was immutable, he was nothing like that. *Ignoring whispered words in a place only they could be, of a weak spot and a bone destined to give out eventually.* If there ever was going to be a person who died for the Flame Chase, it would be him.

And he would have gone into it happily, as long as he knew Mydei would survive.

Even once there was a Coreflame in hand, Strife leaking from it, sinking into their bones and blood, turning into a burning heart in the chest of the one he loved most, he knew he was nothing. A mortal in the face of divine.

A mortal, loved by that divine.

Things shifted, after the Professor that bore Reason threw his destiny in the sunlight. After he gave him the weight of the world, gave him the truth of people.

A *Deliverer*.

Like Cyrene always said.

And for some reason, Mydei still loved him after that. Didn't hate him for not being enough yet, didn't despise him for not yet ushering in the new era. His love was gone, true, prowling the ruins of his home to keep them all safe, but even the greatest of distances couldn't stop the lightning that arced across the sky and brought the calming words of the one who held his whole heart.

Divine comforting something not yet perfect. Not yet divine in his own right.

And if Mydei believed in him, loved him still, then maybe… maybe he really could bring upon the next era. An Era where he and Mydei could be together forever, guiding the beautiful world they called their own.

So he plunged forward.

Thanatos.

Cerces

Aquila.

The deaths… oh they hurt.

Anaxa, his time running out and leaving behind a single, final lesson.

Castorice, sacrificing everything to reopen death and life.

Aglaea, by those who schemed against them.

But he pushed on. Because he knew he would see them again in the next life. Cyrene knew as well. Her own ascension… he had never cheered louder.

And then…

And then…

LYGUS.

The damned sinner who he took particular enjoyment in beheading anytime he got the chance.

And he thought of his love, his prince, his Mydei, who had died, died and he couldn't even mourn, who had believed in the prophecy, in the truth, in their *world.*

He couldn't let him down. Couldn't let him die for nothing.

Khaslana had long since accepted that he would do *anything* for his golden prince. Including beating back the end of the world over and over and over again.

~

But it feels like an eternity

Since I had you here with me

Since I had to learn to be

Someone you don't know.

~

Now… now he still loved Mydei as much as he had that first night. Even as the memory of that night faded, the feelings buried under pain and hurt and all the Coreflames of cycle after cycle, he still loved him. He watched him in every cycle, watched the way he always circled around that cycle's version of Phainon. Sometimes it became romantic like it had the first, sometimes it didn't. Sometimes they adored each other even more than they had that first time but they *never* hated each other. There was never true disgust between them even as the competitions got too much sometimes or each struggled with grief and pain and the knowledge that each were the last of something.

Every cycle stood to the same truth.

Mydeimos of Castrum Kremnos and Phainon of Aedes Elysiae could never live a life where they weren't together.

Perhaps it should have given him comfort, that each version of his love had at least one bright spot in the lives that they led.

In past cycles, when he still meddled, he had skewered Eurypon before he could throw Mydei into the ocean. Had placed child Mydei in the care of Aglaea or Anaxa or whoever was the most stable in that cycle. Had absconded with Gorgo before she could die to her husband, so she could raise her son alone or be there for him when he emerged from the sea. Had done countless things, countless times, and ***yet…***

He had stopped trying to meddle with the others hundreds of cycles prior but he couldn't pull himself away from Mydei until at least the first million mark. He could never stop trying to make his love's life easier.

It never did anything.

He started to hate the Titans. Hate the Coreflames. Hate the destiny that was laid down for Mydei.

Why? Why did it have to be Mydei? Even in the cycles where Phainon got there first, where Krateros tried or Gorgo in a couple or his friends in one, why did Mydei always have to become the Titan of Strife? Why did he have to be the one to make the sacrifice, to make himself more, better, beautiful?

Why did Mydei have to always put himself in way of the mission to stop the end of the world? Why did he have to fight Mydei each life?

Golden blood, lapping at his ankles. Red crystals, broken gauntlets. Over and over and *over and over and over* ***and over and over!***

Why?

The others, he could kill fine. It haunted him in the first couple hundred lives, haunted him how they fell to his hands, how easy it became to snuff out their lives because they would always be back, never knowing what had happened before. Each of them, he had killed dozens of times, as mortals, as Demi-Gods, as Titans.

He killed them all.

And yet, every time he was faced with his love, even as he learned more of his moves and killed him quicker and quicker, *always the back always the weakness that had been entrusted to him in such confidence*, it still tore apart his Coreflame-buried heart. He wanted to hold Mydei close, shield him from the world, raise him up and let him shine like he was always meant to.

He knew that wasn't what destiny had for them, none of them were real after all, but he could still hope. Hope was the only thing keeping him sane. If he even was still sane.

When a cycle would end, a sword in his chest and the knowledge passing onto the next to continue their long legacy, he always died dreaming of Mydei. Dreaming of the world where maybe they could be happy.

He would make that world. He had to. At some point, there *must* be a time where he is powerful enough to create that paradise for all of them.

The Flame Reaver would make the world safe for his love.

~

To be with you in paradise

What I wouldn't sacrifice

Why'd you have to chase the light

Somewhere I can't go?

End Notes

Well, I would like all of you to go listen to Eternity by Alex Warren and picture it from Khaslana's POV to Mydei. And then try not to cry like me at like 1 am two days ago.

This was just something short I pounded out in like an hour. I just really wanted to write something about these two relating to the song. It's not my best work, I know, but I wanted *something*. I know I should be updating my other works, but this wouldn't leave my mind ever since I first heard the song.

These two make me so mentally ill.

Anways, comments and kudos are always appreciated, I promise I'll get back to my other works now, go listen to the song. (And the album, it's really good)

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!